

Personal Statement

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Program: Robotics M.S.

The defining cadence of my undergraduate years was set in a pool. As a varsity swimmer and City-Level Gold Medalist, I learned that physical exhaustion is temporary, but the grit required to push through it is permanent. I applied this same resilience to a significant academic barrier: pivoting from Mechanical Engineering (ME) to Computer Science (CS).

Navigating this transition was isolating; entering the world of algorithms from a background of thermodynamics initially made me feel like an outsider. However, this struggle gave me a unique vantage point. I realized my value lay not just in mastering code, but in bridging the physical constraints of hardware with the abstract logic of software. This experience clarified my purpose: to build truly robust embodied systems, I needed to unify the physical intuition of mechanics with the algorithmic reasoning of AI.

This shaped my core identity as a “Technical Bridge.” As Chapter Lead of the Google Developer Student Club (GDSC), I noticed non-CS majors often felt intimidated by technical jargon. Acting as a “Translator,” I mentored students by framing coding concepts through diverse metaphors—such as explaining API logic to a Literature major as narrative grammar. Her breakthrough reinforced my belief that cross-disciplinary friction is fuel for innovation. By orchestrating workshops for over 40 diverse students, I fostered an ecosystem where electrical engineers could fearlessly debate architecture with software theorists.

My commitment to engineering extends to “human-centered logistics.” Initiating a meal distribution program for the homeless in Taipei taught me that optimization metrics fail when they ignore human dignity. Managing these logistics aligned me deeply with the ethos of “Robotics for the People,” reminding me that a robotic system is only as robust as its ability to serve the most vulnerable.

I seek to join the University of Michigan to contribute to a community that values this breadth of perspective. The Robotics Institute is the ideal environment to refine my role as a technical bridge-builder. I plan to actively participate in the culture of the Ford Robotics Building, organizing roundtables that connect students focused on “Reasoning” with those focused on “Acting.” By sharing my experience navigating the friction between ME and CS, I hope to ensure the Michigan Robotics community remains not just intellectually elite, but profoundly inclusive.